

Forest Service - Industry Q&A
Regional Vault & Septic Pumping Services IDIQ – 127EAS26R0003

The Forest Service is providing this Question & Answer document to support transparency and help interested vendors prepare for the upcoming solicitation **127EAS26R0003 – Regional Vault & Septic Pumping Services (Multiple Award IDIQ)**.

The questions included here reflect actual inquiries received from industry following the release of draft documents on SAM.gov and during early engagement with potential offerors. Each response is intended to clarify draft materials, assist with planning, and ensure all vendors—new or existing—have equal access to the same information.

Because the solicitation is still in development, this Q&A is provided **for planning purposes only**. Final terms, instructions, pricing templates, and seed task orders may change before the official Request for Proposals (RFP) is released. Any updates or additional clarifications will be provided in future SAM.gov postings.

During the pre-solicitation and solicitation phases, this Q&A will serve in three ways:

1. **Pre-solicitation Phase** – Helps offerors understand the intent of the draft documents, anticipate how the IDIQ will function, and identify where final details will be clarified in the upcoming RFP.
2. **Solicitation Release** – Once the RFP is posted, this document will be updated and re-issued (as applicable) to reflect final language and address new questions received during the formal Q&A window.
3. **Proposal Preparation** – Ensures all offerors have a consistent understanding of the requirements, pricing structure, and submission expectations outlined in the Performance Work Statement (PWS), Schedule of Items (SOI), and final solicitation terms.

We appreciate the time and effort that industry partners invest in reviewing draft documents and asking thoughtful questions. Your engagement strengthens the quality, clarity, and success of this important contracting effort.

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Item No.	Question	Government Response
1.	“I only see a Presolicitation on SAM.gov and all documents are marked DRAFT. Where can I find the actual solicitation, checklist, and the email for submitting our proposal?”	At this time, no final solicitation has been issued. The documents currently posted on SAM.gov — including the PWS (Attachment J.2), Schedule of Items (Attachment J.3), Maps and Locations (Attachment J.4–J.5), and draft SF1449 (Attachment J.1) — are drafts for planning purposes only. They are intentionally marked DRAFT and are not to be used for proposal submission. Once internal approval and final reviews are complete, the Government will post the official RFP, including: • Final SF1449 • Final Attachments J.1–J.19 • Submission instructions • Proposal email instructions. All official submissions must be made only after the final solicitation is posted.
2.	“The A10+J3 SOI Excel spreadsheet doesn’t match in columns C and D between the base year and option years. Is this intentional?”	The base year and option year worksheets reflect formatting updates that were made as the Schedule of Items evolved during draft development. The underlying pricing structure, required entries, and quantity groupings remain the same across all years. The final solicitation will include fully aligned formats for all tabs/years.
2a.	2a. “What unit of measure do you want for Travel? Hourly? Per minute? Per mile? It’s unclear.”	Travel is compensated using the tiered round-trip time structure described in the PWS Section Travel and reflected in Attachment J.3 SOI. The unit of measure is “Per Each (EA)” per travel-time tier, not per hour or mile. Offerors will price each tiered bracket as a fixed rate per task order.
2b.	2b. “When it says ‘1 unit at site,’ does that mean one truck or one toilet?”	“1 unit” refers to one facility (vault toilet, septic tank, or USFS-owned portable toilet), not the number of trucks. The SOI quantities represent individual serviced sites, as defined in Attachment J.4 (Geographic Locations) and PWS Section Scope of Work. Truck and staffing requirements are determined by the contractor.

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3.	I missed the virtual pre-proposal conference on 3/18/2026. Was it recorded? Can I watch it?”	The 03/18/2026 virtual industry session was not recorded, consistent with agency practice. However, content from the session has been incorporated into the updated PWS (Attachment J.2) and SOI (Attachment J.3). All offerors will have full and equal access to those materials when the final solicitation is posted.
3a.	“Are previous contracts or awarded prices publicly available?”	Yes — previous USFS contracts, task orders, and award prices are publicly available through USASpending.gov or FOIA request. No single prior contract represents the scope of this new consolidated Regional IDIQ, as many forests previously procured these services independently or via BPAs.
4.	“Is this a brand-new contract? If not, who is the incumbent?”	Yes—this is a new regional contracting opportunity. In the past, individual Forests procured these services through their own stand-alone contracts, purchase orders, or through the now-expired regional BPAs. Because these previous actions were awarded and administered independently, there is no single incumbent for this requirement. The upcoming IDIQ will be an additional optional tool available for Forest units when it best meets their operational needs.